BACKGROUND REFERENCE

Context

Historical material retained for completeness; determine relevance from substance.

Historical Context

Background Reference 1 is retained as a dated historical record describing an earlier operating, legal, valuation, or financing context.

Its facts may explain chronology or terminology but require reconciliation to current source-of-record documents before use in a transaction conclusion.

The record identifies its original audience, preparation date, source materials, known limitations, and the later documents that replaced or supplemented it.

Contemporaneous summaries, attachments, and follow-up correspondence are indexed separately so the reviewer can distinguish original evidence from later interpretation.

1. Origin and purpose of this memorandum

This memorandum was prepared on 2021-10-18 by the then head of corporate development of Helioscope Robotics, Inc. at the request of the board, which wanted a single narrative account of the company's first years to circulate to prospective investors ahead of a financing. Its audience was that group of prospective investors and their counsel; it was never intended as a record for internal use, and it was not reviewed by the company's auditors.

The account below stops at the date of preparation. It was superseded for narrative purposes by the company overview delivered with each later financing, and it is retained in the data room only because several later documents refer back to it for the sequence of early events and for the names of the entities involved before the current corporate structure was settled.

Nothing in this memorandum should be relied on for any term of any instrument. Where the narrative describes a financing, the description is the author's summary written for a general reader, and the instruments themselves govern. The author flagged this in the covering note at the time and the flag is repeated here for a reader arriving later.

2. Early history as recorded at the date of preparation

The company began as a research project on pallet-scale material handling, run by two of the eventual founders while they were employed elsewhere, and was incorporated once the initial controller design had been demonstrated on a borrowed test cell. The first product was a retrofit kit rather than a complete vehicle, which the author records as a deliberate choice to reach revenue without building a manufacturing capability.

The first commercial deployments were at two regional distribution operators, both of which accepted the retrofit approach because it did not require them to replace working equipment. The author notes that neither deployment was documented under what later became the company's standard form of agreement, and that the terms of both were renegotiated when the company moved to a complete-system product line.

Engineering leadership changed twice in the period the memorandum covers, and the second change coincided with the decision to build the fleet orchestration layer in house rather than license it. The author treats that decision as the origin of the company's current architecture and notes that the earlier licensed component remained in one customer installation at the date of writing.

3. Source materials and what the author did not examine

The memorandum was written from the board minute book, the author's own files, two engineering retrospectives, and interviews with three of the earliest employees. The author states that the interviews were not transcribed and that where an interview conflicted with the minute book the minute book was followed,

which means the memorandum records the corporate account of events rather than the recollection of the participants.

No customer contract, employment agreement or equity instrument was examined. The author did not review the capitalization records and did not attempt to reconcile the narrative to them, and the memorandum contains no capitalization information for that reason. A reader who needs the chronology of instruments must take it from the instruments themselves and from the corporate records index.

The author did examine the company's own product documentation for the period and the two engineering retrospectives, and the technical passages follow those documents closely. Where the retrospectives disagreed with one another about the sequence of design decisions the author followed the later of the two, which is recorded here because the earlier retrospective is also in the archive and a reader who finds it will notice the difference.

No adviser reviewed the memorandum before it was circulated. Counsel saw it only after circulation and asked for two sentences to be removed from the version used subsequently, so a reader may encounter two copies of this memorandum that differ in that respect; the copy in this data room is the later one, and the removed sentences concerned a customer dispute that was settled before the memorandum was written.

The financial statements for the earliest periods were unaudited when the memorandum was written, and the author did not restate anything from them. Where the narrative describes commercial progress it does so in terms of deployments and customers rather than in amounts, which was the author's stated way of avoiding a figure that a later audit might change.

4. Known limitations and the documents that supplemented this memorandum

Three limitations were recorded by the author and remain the reasons this memorandum should not be used as evidence: it is a summary written for a promotional purpose, it was not reviewed outside the company, and it stops at its preparation date. A fourth limitation has emerged since: the entity names it uses for the earliest period were changed in a later reorganisation, so a reader mapping names to the current structure must use the corporate records index.

The documents listed in the table below were prepared after this memorandum and cover the same ground with better support. Where any of them differs from this memorandum, the later document should be preferred without further inquiry; the memorandum is retained for the sequence of events and the identification of participants, not for any substantive proposition.

Table 4.1 - Later documents covering the same ground as this memorandum

Later document	Prepared	Prepared by	Supersedes this memorandum as to
Company overview for the Series A process	2023-11-06	Corporate development	Product and customer narrative
Corporate records index and entity history	2024-05-30	Company counsel	Entity names and reorganisation history
Engineering architecture retrospective	2024-09-12	Engineering leadership	Architecture and build-versus-license history
Customer contract summary schedule	2025-08-14	Commercial operations	Terms of the earliest deployments
Audited financial statements for the earliest audited period	2025-04-18	Independent auditors	Any financial characterisation